User Guide

Canadian RRSP Multi-Brokerage Tracker

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v1.0

MapleSheet Co.

maplesheetco.etsy.com

Track your RRSP across up to 8 Canadian brokerages in a single Google Sheet. Live prices, ACB, combined contribution room against your real CRA numbers, and a dividend tracker that shows your US withholding tax savings — all automatic.

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1. GETTING STARTED

Open your template link

The **Template_Link.pdf** in your download contains a clickable link to the master spreadsheet. Click it, then click **Make a copy** in the dialog that appears. Google creates a personal copy in your Google Drive. From this point on, you work only in your own copy — the master is untouched.

Rename your copy

In the top-left of the sheet, click the title (currently something like "Copy of Canadian RRSP Multi-Brokerage Tracker v1.0") and rename it to something you'll recognize — for example: **RRSP Multi-Brokerage Tracker 2026 — Your Name**.

Reload the browser tab

This is important. After your first open, **close and reopen the browser tab** (or press Ctrl+R / Cmd+R to reload). Wait 5–10 seconds. A new menu called ■ MapleSheet appears next to the Help menu at the top of the sheet. This menu is the heart of the product — everything you need lives there.

> If the ■ MapleSheet menu does not appear: reload the tab one more time. Google sometimes takes an extra moment to load bound scripts on the very first open.

2. THE ■ MAPLESHEET MENU

The ■ MapleSheet menu contains every command you'll need to run. You never have to touch the Apps Script editor — everything is one click.

■ Load Sample Data

Pre-fills the Transaction Log with realistic sample transactions across several brokerages so you can see how everything connects before entering your real data. Also sets example numbers in Settings so the dashboards show real figures.

■ Clear Sample Data

Wipes the Transaction Log. Formulas, dropdowns, formatting, and Settings all stay intact — only the sample data rows are cleared. **Always run this before entering your real transactions.**

Menu command names above are confirmed from the tracker's own Start Here tab. If your version's ■ MapleSheet menu also includes Build/Rebuild All Tabs, Rebuild Dashboard Charts, or About commands (as the TFSA tracker does), they work the same way — see the TFSA User Guide's Section 2 for what each one does, and check your menu directly against this list before this document ships.

3. YOUR FIRST RUN — RECOMMENDED ORDER

Follow these steps in order. Most of the time is spent gathering two numbers from the CRA, not using the sheet itself.

1	Reload the browser tab. Confirm the ■ MapleSheet menu appears.
2	■ MapleSheet → Load Sample Data. Look around the dashboards to see how everything connects.
3	■ MapleSheet → Clear Sample Data. This wipes the Transaction Log but keeps all formulas and dropdowns.
4	Open ■ Settings & Goals. Fill in the amber cells: your name, province, Active Year, birth year, your institutions (up to 8), and — most important — your **RRSP Deduction Limit** and **Unused Room Carried Forward** from your CRA Notice of Assessment (NOA).
5	Open ■ Transaction Log. Add your real transactions, one row per transaction. The dashboards populate automatically.

Your Total Available Room matters most. It's the sum of your RRSP Deduction Limit and Unused Room Carried Forward in Settings — both come from CRA My Account under Tax Returns → RRSP. Every over-contribution warning and every "room remaining" figure on the dashboards is measured against this number.

4. TOUR OF THE 7 TABS

Tab	What it does
■ Start Here	Quick-start steps and a menu overview. Read this first.
■ Main Dashboard	Per-institution and combined contribution room, YTD dividends/withdrawals, and two auto-updating charts.
■ Transaction Log	Your single source of truth — one row per transaction. Every other tab reads from it.
■ RRSP Portfolio	Combined holdings, live prices, ACB, and gain/loss across every brokerage.
■ Institution Dashboard	Side-by-side comparison across all 8 brokerages.
■ Dividend Tracker	Monthly income vs. goal, per-ticker breakdown, annual run-rate, and US withholding tax saved.
■ Settings & Goals	The only tab you edit directly (amber cells). Your info, brokerages, CRA numbers, and goals.

5. THE TRANSACTION LOG — COLUMN BY COLUMN

The Transaction Log is the only tab you type into. Every other tab reads from it. Never delete rows — your Adjusted Cost Base (ACB) depends on the full history.

Col	Field	How to fill it in
A	Date	Format: yyyy-mm-dd. Example: 2026-01-20.
B	Year	Auto. Fills from column A. Do not edit.
C	Institution ▼	Dropdown. Pulls names from Settings' Institution Names section.
D	Type ▼	Dropdown: Contribution, Withdrawal, Buy, Dividend, DRIP (confirm the full list in your own copy's dropdown).
E	Ticker	US stocks: ticker only, no prefix (KO, not NASDAQ:KO). Canadian tickers still need the TSE: prefix (TSE:XEQT).
F	Description	Free-text. Optional. E.g. 'iShares All-Equity ETF'.
G	Currency ▼	Dropdown: CAD or USD. This — not the ticker prefix — drives accurate CAD conversion.
H	Shares / Units	Required for Buy / Sell / DRIP. Blank for Contribution / Withdrawal / Dividend.
I	Price / Share	Required for Buy / Sell / DRIP.
J	Commission	Brokerage fee. Use 0 for commission-free institutions.
K	Amt (Original)	Cash amount in the transaction's currency.
L	FX Rate (auto)	Auto. Uses your Settings override if set, otherwise the live GOOGLEFINANCE rate.
M	Amt (CAD) ★ (auto)	Auto. Locked. Amt (Original) × FX Rate, rounded to 2 decimals. Never edit.

6. UNDERSTANDING THE DASHBOARDS

Main Dashboard

Your executive summary. The top block shows your RRSP Deduction Limit, Unused Room Carried Forward, and the Total Available Room they add up to, next to what you've contributed YTD across every institution and how much room remains. Two charts below break down YTD contributions and monthly dividend + DRIP income.

The four contribution room states

- **OVER-CONTRIBUTED** — past your Total Available Room by more than the CRA's $2,000 lifetime buffer. Withdraw the excess as soon as possible; CRA charges 1% per month on the amount past the buffer.
- **Within the $2,000 buffer** — past your Total Available Room, but still inside CRA's one-time lifetime allowance. Not ideal to leave in place, but not penalized.
- **Close to limit** — a small amount of room remaining across all institutions.
- **OK** — room remaining shown as a dollar amount. Safe to keep contributing.

Institution Dashboard

Side-by-side comparison. Each column is one of your brokerages, with a combined column at the end. Rows show market value, cost basis, gain/loss, contributions YTD, and dividends YTD. Useful for deciding whether to consolidate or seeing which institution is actually carrying your returns.

7. TICKER FORMATS AND LIVE PRICES

The tracker uses Google Sheets' **GOOGLEFINANCE** function to pull live prices. This tracker simplifies US tickers compared to older MapleSheet trackers: enter the ticker alone, with no exchange prefix.

Market	How to enter it	Examples
US stocks (NASDAQ / NYSE)	Ticker only — no prefix	KO · JNJ · AAPL
Canadian stocks (TSX)	TSE: prefix required	TSE:XEQT · TSE:VDY

If a price shows #N/A: double-check a Canadian ticker has its TSE: prefix, or try File → Spreadsheet settings → Recalculation → 'On change and every minute'.

8. CURRENCY AND FX RATES

US-dollar transactions are automatically converted to CAD. The tracker uses the live USD/CAD rate from GOOGLEFINANCE unless you set an override in Settings.

When to use the override: for historical accuracy — if you bought a US stock months ago, the current live rate is not the rate you actually paid. Enter your actual purchase-day rate in the Settings override cell so your cost basis reflects reality. Leave it blank for live conversion.

9. CONTRIBUTION ROOM — HOW THE TRACKER MEASURES IT

RRSP room works differently from a TFSA's. There is no annual reset to track separately — you have one running Total Available Room made of two CRA numbers: your **RRSP Deduction Limit** (this year's new room, after pension adjustments) and your **Unused Room Carried Forward** (everything unused from every prior year). The tracker adds these together and measures every contribution, across every brokerage, against that one total.

Unlike a TFSA, a withdrawal does **not** add room back. RRSP withdrawals are simply gone from your available room (and are taxable — see the RRSP Government Rules PDF in your download).

Where to find your numbers: sign in to CRA My Account (canada.ca/my-account) → Tax Returns → RRSP. Your Notice of Assessment states your RRSP Deduction Limit directly. Update both numbers once every January after you've filed.

10. DIVIDEND TRACKING

The ■ Dividend Tracker tab analyzes all your dividend and DRIP income. Log each dividend as a row in the Transaction Log with Type = Dividend or Type = DRIP.

Cash dividend

Type = Dividend. Fill Ticker, Currency, and Amt (Original). Leave Shares and Price blank. The tracker converts USD dividends to CAD automatically.

DRIP (Dividend Reinvestment)

Type = DRIP. Fill Ticker, Shares (the fractional shares you received), Price (share price on the DRIP date), and Amt (Original) = shares × price. This increases your ACB, which the Portfolio tab handles automatically.

The US withholding tax savings estimate

Because the Canada–US tax treaty exempts RRSPs from the 15% US dividend withholding tax that applies in a TFSA, the Dividend Tracker estimates how much withholding tax you're saving this year by holding US dividend stocks inside this RRSP instead. See Section 19 of the RRSP Government Rules PDF for the full explanation.

Set your annual dividend goal

Your Settings annual dividend goal drives the Dividend Tracker's monthly target (goal ÷ 12) and Goal Progress %. Setting a goal makes the whole tab more useful.

11. ANNUAL ROLLOVER — EVERY JANUARY

The tracker is designed to keep running year after year. You never delete history — you just update a few numbers each January, exactly as the tracker's own Settings tab checklist describes:

- File → Make a copy → Rename: ‘RRSP Multi-Brokerage Tracker 2027’
- Settings → change Active Year from 2026 to 2027
- Update RRSP Deduction Limit from your new CRA Notice of Assessment (NOA)
- Update Unused Room Carried Forward if you did not fully contribute this year
- Confirm your RRIF Conversion Year is still correct (Birth Year + 71)
- Start adding 2027 transactions below your existing rows — that's all. Holdings carry forward automatically: ACB preserved, history intact.

DO NOT delete Transaction Log rows. The Portfolio tab computes your Adjusted Cost Base (ACB) from the full history of every Buy, DRIP, and Sell. Deleting old rows corrupts your cost basis. Also remember: you have until March 1 of the following year (not December 31) to make a contribution and still claim this year's deduction.

12. TROUBLESHOOTING

The ■ MapleSheet menu is missing

Reload the browser tab (Ctrl+R / Cmd+R) and wait 5–10 seconds. If it still does not appear, close the tab entirely, then reopen the file from your Google Drive.

Live prices show #N/A or 0

Check column E of the Transaction Log. US tickers need no prefix; Canadian tickers need the TSE: prefix. Also try File → Spreadsheet settings → Recalculation → 'On change and every minute'.

Contribution room shows the wrong number

Check your RRSP Deduction Limit and Unused Room Carried Forward in Settings — every room calculation on every dashboard is measured against these two numbers. An old value from a prior year is the most common cause.

Portfolio tab tickers are missing

The Portfolio tab pulls unique tickers from the Transaction Log. Make sure every Buy/DRIP/Sell row has a ticker in column E with the correct prefix rule from Section 7.

I accidentally deleted something important

File → Version history → See version history → restore an earlier version. Google keeps every edit.

13. SUPPORT AND UPDATES

Message the shop on Etsy: maplesheetco.etsy.com — reply within 1–2 business days.

If you spot a bug or want to request a feature, include: the tab name, the cell reference, a screenshot if possible, and the product version.

For educational purposes only. Not financial or tax advice. Always verify your CRA numbers against your actual Notice of Assessment and CRA My Account.